

LLM-Based Recommender System Project Rubric						
Category	Total Points	Description	Point Levels			
Problem Definition	15	Clarity of domain, user needs, recommendation goal	15-13	12-9	8-5	4-0
			Very clear problem definition; domain and objective fully explained.	Mostly clear; minor gaps.	Vague; unclear user need or objective.	Little to no coherent problem statement.
Data & Inputs	15	Data used, preprocessing, structure of the data	15-13	12-9	8-5	4-0
			Data sources clearly described; preprocessing steps explained.	Data described with minor missing details.	Minimal explanation.	No meaningful description of data.
LLM & System Design	30	Pipeline, prompt design, how LLM is used, justification	30-27	26-20	19-12	11-0
			Clear pipeline; thoughtful prompting; LLM has a defined role (ranking, scoring, reranking, filtering, explaining); design decisions justified.	Pipeline works but with limited justification.	Basic functionality; LLM usage shallow or unclear.	Disorganized, incoherent, or unjustified design.
Evaluation	25	How well the recommender is tested/assessed	25-23	22-18	17-11	10-0
			Sensible evaluation (e.g. human eval, test cases, consistency checks, qualitative analysis) with interpretation of results.	Some evaluation; partially interpreted.	Minimal evaluation; weak analysis.	No evaluation or irrelevant evaluation with zero to no analysis.
Final Reflections	15	Critical thinking about failures, weaknesses, improvements	15-13	12-9	8-5	4-0
			Clear limitations, failure cases, and improvement ideas; thoughtful reflection.	Some limitations discussed.	Shallow reflection.	No meaningful reflection.

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